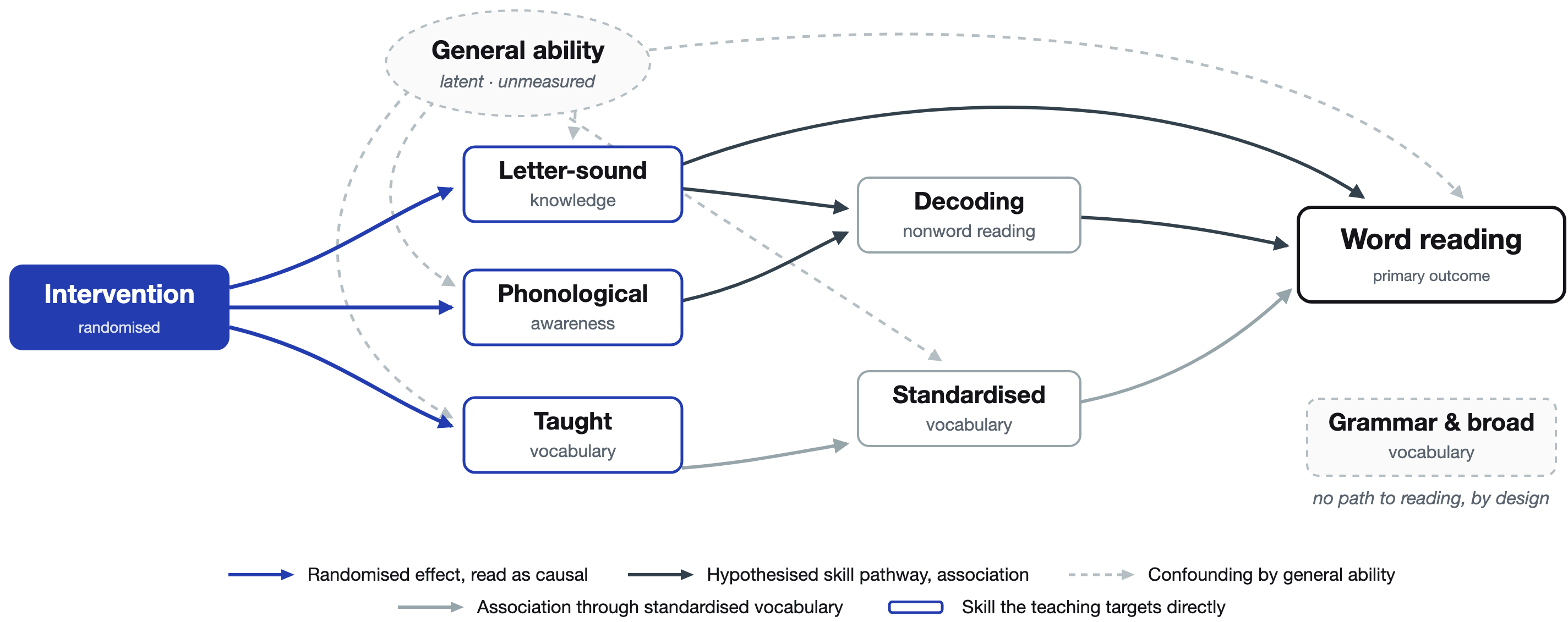


Causal structure assumed in the reading analysis

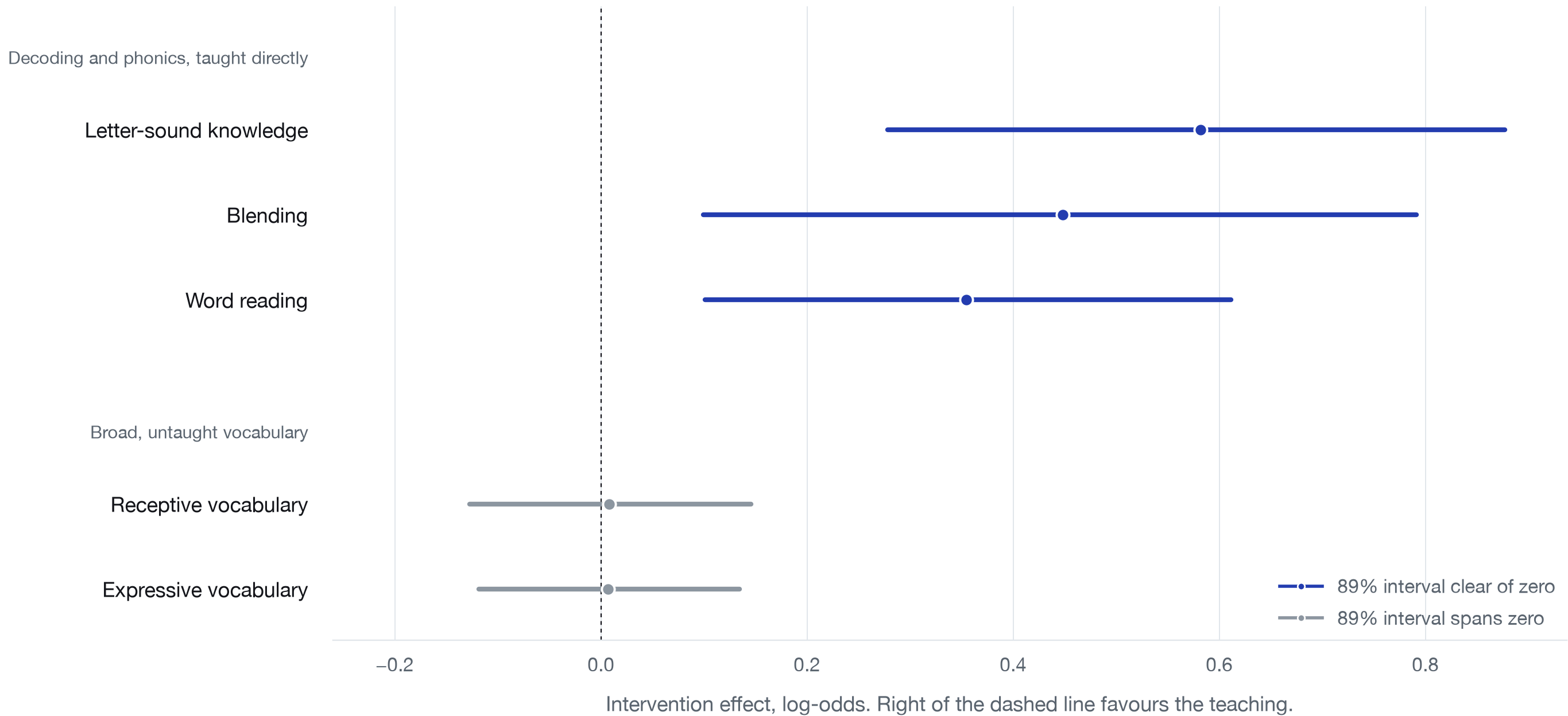
Randomisation makes the intervention independent of general ability, so its effects on the skills it targets are read as causal. Every skill-to-skill link stays confounded by ability and is reported as association, not cause.



Source: Down Syndrome Education International, Reading and Language Intervention trial re-analysis; simplified from the study's 20-node causal diagram. Estimation: gradient-boosting discovery, then DAG-identified Bayesian models (intention-to-treat, difference-in-differences). 54 children. Preliminary.

Effect of the reading intervention on each skill

Intention-to-treat estimates on the log-odds scale with 89% equal-tailed intervals; 54 children randomised to the teaching or a waiting list. Right of zero favours the teaching. Blue intervals exclude zero; grey intervals span it.



Source: Down Syndrome Education International, Reading and Language Intervention trial, Bayesian re-analysis; single-outcome models, reporting-tier fits of 21 July 2026. Randomisation identifies these effects as causal; effects on broad vocabulary are not distinguishable from zero. Preliminary.